

CREATIVE WRITING COLLABORATIVE
PRESENTS:

SWITCHING PLACES



TABLE OF CONTENTS

~Spotlight Stories~

The Untimely Turn of Events with a Scepter , by Anika Sista	1
The Magic Forest , by Mohnish Premnath	4
Kitty Catastrophe , by Mahiya Srivastava	7
The Neighbor Switch , by Meghna Srivarshini	10
	
The Switch , by Anjali Vijayanand	13
A Harry Potter Switch , by Annika Jivrajani	14
The Big Switch , by Jasveet Kaur	15
Allen to Myself , by Jeffery Chen	16
Change with 5th Grader , by Krishna Siddharth	17
A Freaky Day , by Roshni Kabra	18
My Mom's Life , by Sahana Jayathilak	19
The Big Spell! by Sanjana Vijayanand	21

The Untimely Turn of Events with a Scepter

By: Anika Sista

“Let me go get them!” my sister yelled in a shrill voice. It was a windy day and the leaves seemed to be running around, skipping with each hop. Not a setting to be arguing in, especially in town. Even with thousands of strangers walking everywhere, I could see a small crowd gathering around us, watching my sister throw a tantrum.

“Come on,” I said angrily as I grabbed her hand and ducked past the people in front of us, “You are going to stay here while I go for the groceries and *if you dare follow* then you’re not coming to Disneyland in August.” I knew it was a half-bribe, but I didn’t regret it.

We were already five minutes late and if she took ten steps inside Mr. McLane’s Grocery Store, then she would go straight for the grapes. It would end up with me saying sorry to the manager and giving him a buck and a half, which mom would’ve wanted me to spend on at least a bunch of bananas. My sister didn’t refuse or say that our dad had announced that he had enough money for four tickets. She just sat down on the nearest bench and fiddled with her fingers. Then, I knew it had worked.

I walked into the grocery store, my mind on croissants and apples when I accidentally knocked into a stranger with big glasses, gray hair, and a striped red shirt. My mom told me not to talk to strangers unless it was to apologize for something, so I did. He straightened his spectacles and looked at me curiously.

“That’s alright, I was just inspecting this strange thing,” he told me with his eyes twinkling. He shifted to reveal an object and I was shocked. It was a scepter, as black as coal and inside its holder was a blood-red gem. I can’t seem to take my eyes off the strange thing--it seemed like magic.

“Fascinating huh?” said the man, watching my expression.

I managed to tear my pupils off it as I asked him, “Where’d you get that thing?” then realized I was being rude and gave myself a mental lecture. But the man seemed to be more amused than upset.

“I found it lying in the pantry but it seems a little peculiar that I haven’t seen it before,” he shrugged as he continued, “I brought it to town before Chewy, my dog, could swallow it. He eats anything he can find.”

“I, um, you’re not willing to sell it are you?” I asked before I could lose the courage to do so. There was a 50% chance he’d say no but I felt like I wanted to bring that scepter home without any hands touching it. But he surprised me.

“Sure,” he said as he laughed, “I won’t be using it anyways.”

“Anika!”

What? Where? How? I thought as I turned around to face the door and saw a flash of pigtails, an innocent smile, and a look that read, *Wherever you got that thing, I WANT IT.* She skipped right up to me and looked me straight in the eye with no hesitation.

“Where’d you get that?” she asked, pointing at the scepter in my hand. I ignored her and turned around to face the man but he was gone. I sighed and grabbed Vi’s hand as I walked past people and grabbed bananas, bread, and tomatoes. As we walked to the checkout, my sister kept eyeing the scepter and tried to grab it twice. When she reached for it the third time I slapped her hand away.

“Stop it,” I hissed as we walked out of the store and back on the streets. “You’re not me, so don’t tell me what to do,” she shot back as she grabbed the scepter. She must’ve pushed a button or something because in about five seconds she looked *exactly like me.*

“What--” I trailed off, lost in my sentence as I looked at my hands. They were small. *Too* small. And was I wearing a *PAW PATROL SHIRT*? A crazy thought came to my head and I laughed as I recalled it. My voice came in as a high giggle and I stopped.

What. Just. Happened.

“What’s going on?” Vi demanded, looking at me for an answer. But I didn’t have one. All I had was pigtails with pink ribbons in them, a shirt that had a picture of the show I groaned at, and a sickly sweet voice that made me want to throw up.

How did this happen? I thought angrily. *Did the scepter guy find it in his pantry or was he lying the whole time? Did he know that it changed bodies? Then why didn’t he warn me?* I gave up and started walking back to our house. This was crazy. A real nightmare.

“Vi, go eat your applesauce!” our mom called from the basement. I groaned. There were some parts of this whole ‘being my sister’ situation that were really annoying. I walked to the cabinet where we keep the applesauce cups and stared at the mushy stuff inside. *There is no way I can eat this without gagging* I thought to myself. Vi appeared at the edge of the kitchen table, her eyes looking scared.

“If you’re eating that,” she asked, pointing to the applesauce, “Does that mean I have to eat an *apple*?”

“How about we switch breakfasts for today?” I suggested, grabbing an apple from the fruit bowl. She nodded and took a granola bar and an applesauce cup.

“You’re lucky that it’s summer break,” I told her. “If it was a school day you’d have to do fractions and decimals.”

“Yeah okay,” she said, walking away, “But you better remember to do my summer homework!” And with that, she was gone. *Summer homework? What summer homework?* I thought to myself. I went over to her desk where a paper crown sat. It looked like it was glued and on the gold part it said, “***I, ----- am now in Math is Fun Summer Camp!***” In the blank space, my sister had written down her name. On another piece of paper, it said, “***From 11:00 am to 2:00 pm.***” I felt panic rise in me. I looked at the big clock in the living room. 10:47 a.m. Great. Just awesome. In the time of that camp, I could have done something like try to reverse the crazy

spell. Now I had to sit still and listen to counselors go on and on about kindergarten math. This was getting worse and worse.

“Hello and good afternoon students!” a sweet voice came from the computer, “I’m your counselor Jill Star and welcome to Math is Fun! Today we are going to learn how to add!” *I already know how to add!* I wanted to scream at the computer. Jill Star held up flashcards with numbers on them and started showing them to us.

“O-N-E,” she said slowly, pointing to the white “1” printed on the card. I think the other kids knew their numbers because I saw a kid take off his mini headphones and two others yawning. Jill must’ve noticed them because she put down the flashcards and gave everyone a big smile.

“Since you all know about numbers and how to add and subtract them, we’re going to have a quiz!” she smiled again and then said, “Please open your folders to the pink paper.” *Yes, of course, I would if I could! But sorry I can’t because I have more important things to worry about like changing back into my body. I DON’T HAVE TIME FOR A QUIZ!* I thought in my head. But Jill Star was way ahead of me and was already telling everyone to write their names on the blank line, next to the word that spelled out N-A-M-E.

“I will let you have 30 minutes to do this,” Jill Star told us, “Ready, Set, Goooooooo!” As I sharpened my pencil, the same thought kept coming to me. Will we ever switch back?

Finally! I thought when Jill announced the end of camp for today. She waved to all of us then held her arms up like she wanted to hug us. Anyone who saw it would think she was our mom but I didn’t care. I went to my room, to the closet to be exactly where I had stashed the scepter. It looked pale like it just ate a plate of Brussel sprouts.

“Come on, do your magic,” I murmured to the scepter. I felt stupid talking to something that wasn’t alive, but I was desperate. It worked or at least something happened. The stone stuck in the scepter glowed then faded. I still wasn’t sure if that was positive or negative so I tried to shake it, hoping it would work.

“That’s not going to work,” my voice came from the door.

“Go away Vi,” I told her as I tried to get the stone out. Sixteen tries later I still failed to get the scepter to switch us back and Vi was searching through the closet.

“Do you think that scepter person is still at the store?” she asked me.

“It’s a quarter to three,” I replied, “Do you really think that he’s been hanging out there for seven hours?” She gave me a look then turned around to leave.

“Fine,” she said, “I don’t care if you want to become yourself again but I do.” She kicked away a soccer ball then closed the door behind her. I groaned then followed her outside where we scouted through the streets, looking for the man who brought us all this trouble.

To Be Continued.



The Magic Forest

By: Mohnish Premnath

Part 1: The Magic Forest

Like always, in a scintillating city, there were two friends, Mohnish and Kenneth. One day, Mohnish called Kenneth on the phone saying, “Kenneth, should we go on a trip to a forest for you know, bonding and stuff?” Mohnish was waiting for Kenneth after packing up.

Kenneth said with excitement, “Okay, I will pack everything I need.” Mohnish was only packing a binocular and boomerang for the trip.

They were both ready, and an old man rode the jeep to the forest. Before he left, he said, “You only have a matter of time, GET OUT WHILE YOU CAN!!!” They both went into the forest anyway. The minute they stepped in, something out of this world happened. There were animals of all kinds, but weirdly they were all mixed up. The friends were exploring until they came across a duck-billed bear.

Kenneth pushed Mohnish, and said, “He is tastier, I taste like seafood,” even though it was harmless. Ever since then, they both have been fighting in the forest. They found a coin in the center of the forest. When they both touched it, their bodies changed. They felt very strange like their DNAs changed. They both screamed so loud that the whole forest heard them. They walked and walked all the way to the cave.

When they got in, they saw a pile of human bones. That is when they saw a baby dragon. When they patted it, it grew fangs and tried to bite them. They ran and ran with a grown-up dragon behind them. They ran into another dragon who was in bad health. All the food and water they had was now to the dragon.

Kenneth said, “Now what?”

Mohnish said, “We fight fire with fire” with that, the dragons fought. The good dragon won because we threw a chili in its mouth, as it was breathing fire. They came across a mango tree, and Mohnish in Kenneth's body used the boomerang and got 4 mangoes. They continued until they came up to a tree that said “Answer this riddle, and I will tell you a way to get out of here: What are people who are close together.”

They both answered “Friends”. The tree said that there is a golden tree with a red leaf, and to touch it to get a key that will lead to the exit. As they were walking, they apologized to each other, and the coin turned them back. They went to the golden tree and got the leaf that turned into the key, and they found a keyhole in the tree, and they got out of the forest. The old man said “Not many are lucky but you guys are”, and “I had no doubt. While they were riding back home, Mohnish kept the magic key as a valuable thing to himself. TO BE CONTINUED....

Part 2: The City Invasion

On the jeep, they went home back to the city. Once they got home, they went to the beach. They were playing volleyball, and swimming in the sea. After that, they went home and went to sleep. While Mohnish was sleeping, the magic key flew through his window and made a huge amount of sparkly magic in the entire city.

The next morning, Mohnish woke up out of his bed, and he saw vines in his room. He quickly went to the kitchen, but there were still thorny vines. He called 9-1-1, but they said that they were trapped in the police station. Mohnish grabbed a knife and went outside. He saw vines all over the place, and that is when he realized Kenneth.

He quickly ran to Kenneth's house and saw Kenneth caught in one of the vines. Mohnish cut the vine in two with his knife. They both ran outside, and Mohnish remembered the key. He went back home and checked his room, but no key. They have decided to find the key. On the way, they heard voices in the police station. Mohnish cut the vines, the police helped the people and got them in the warehouse outside the city.

They found the key, but also the talking tree. The tree asked them "WHAT GOES UP, BUT NEVER COMES DOWN?" They both had answers, but different answers. They were angry with each other because they were deciding who should answer, and the magic switched their bodies. They acted like friends, but it did not work. Kenneth got to answer, and they were about to touch it, just when the key made a nature monster. The good dragon was back, and he was fighting with the nature monster, but the monster was bigger and stronger. The two friends hold their hands, and the magic stone comes. It turned them back into their regular selves. The magic stone came to Mohnish's hand, and he threw it to the dragon. The dragon became a mega dragon with a spiky tail, armor, and a red gem on its forehead. With one fireball from the dragon, the monster was defeated.

Suddenly, all the vines and trees vanished. Before the dragon left, it said "I AM NUCLEAR."

Mohnish said, "say 'Hi' to your family for me."

"Nuclear dragons have been extinct for the last 1000 years, he might be the last one," Kenneth said. They comforted nuclear, and he left. All the people were safe, and they were living. They knew the magic objects were dangerous, so Mohnish and Kenneth buried them in their backyards.

Part 3: The Dawn of the Dinosaurs

The next morning, both of the friends woke up. Before they did anything, they headed out to their backyards and checked if the magic objects were there. The magic objects were safe, so they left, and had a normal day. Going to school, relaxing after school, going to the park or beach, doing homework, and going to sleep. This continued for 5 days, until one morning when

they checked, it was gone. They both went back to their house and checked the security cameras that were hidden. When they saw the tape, it was a creepy man with a black cloak and a mask. They went back to the spot where they buried the objects and found a trail of footprints. They followed the trail of footprints to a volcano. They thought the villain threw the magic objects into the volcano, and that is when the villain pushed them into the volcano.

They both were screaming, but instead of dying, they landed in a hot spring. When they got out, they saw the most amazing thing in the whole world. A whole world of dinosaurs. They felt like something was behind them, and when they turned around, there were raptors. They ran and ran until they came across a triceratops. When the triceratops noticed the raptors, it scared them away with its three sharp horns. They saw what happened, and they got out of there. While they were walking, they came past a baby stegosaurus. Kenneth wanted to pat it, but the mama stegosaurus wasn't sure. It attacked the friends, but when they escaped, they saw a sleeping t.rex. Kenneth screamed because of the bones. Mohnish shushed him, and then Mohnish sneezed. The T. Rex woke up and was chasing them. They found a cave to hide in.

Kenneth was angry for sneezing so loud, and Mohnish was angry because of the screaming. The magic stone changed their bodies. That is when they realized the magic object. When they continued to explore the cave, they found a lake. Just when they were about to touch it, a crocodile jumped out. They ran away from the lake. They thought this was an amazing world, but this was a dangerous world.

After they got out of the cave, they found the magic objects, protected by an evil dinosaur. They tiptoed to the magic objects. The dino could sniff them, and it woke up, and it had an army. The bad dinos were about the attack, just when the king of the dinos with an army of good dinosaurs came. The armies fought, and the good dinos were losing. The magic stone turned them back, and Mohnish threw it at the good dinos, and they became stronger, and the good dinos won. The stone came back. The dinos helped them get out of the volcano, and Mohnish and Kenneth went home, and this time, they put the magic objects in their rooms.

Part 4: The Timebreaker

In a place far away from the city, there is a normal house, but under that house is a huge lab where a villain named the timebreaker is found. Now the real story begins in the city where the two friends live. When they checked the magic objects, it was there, so they went to school. In school, Mohnish was concluding about the man in the black cloak and mask. After school, he inspected the tape and went to the spot where the man took the magic objects yesterday in their dino adventure. Mohnish interrogated Kenneth for help, and they went to the volcano. Kenneth examined the footprints, and they traced them back to a house far away from the city.

Mohnish rang the doorbell, and a nice gentleman came to the door. He allowed the friends to come in and sat down on the most luxurious couch in the world. The gentleman's name was Mr. Rich. He owns the most treasure.

They were exploring his house, and Kenneth found a button that said, “Push to get to the lab.”

Mr. Rich said, “NO!!!!” But Kenneth pushed it.

Suddenly, a passageway opened to a secret lab. They checked it out, and Mohnish found the cloak and mask the man was wearing. That is when they realized that Mr. Rich was the man that stole the objects.

Mr. Rich used his machine to capture the friends. He left them and went to the city. He used his time-traveling device to turn people of the city into objects of the past. Mohnish and Kenneth used the magic objects to get out of there. When they returned to the city, it was too late, there was havoc all over the city. The dragon was trying to cease the device, but it couldn't. Suddenly, both of the magic objects were glowing and the dragon too. Then, they turned Mohnish into a superhero with the strength of a nuclear dragon.

When he attacks the machine, it sends him to a different time period like the Jurassic period. Mohnish knew he cannot do it alone, so he went to Kenneth. He gave the same power to Kenneth, and now both of them were superheroes. Mohnish strikes on one side, and Kenneth strikes on the other. The timebreaker finally pushes the turbo button to end the whole city, but the time machine was overheating, and Mohnish and Kenneth made a nuclear blast that destroyed the machine, which killed the timebreaker or Mr. Rich. Mohnish used nature's heal to heal everything. In the end, the dragon came out, and it got his family back because of nature's heal. The people were okay, and they were living. The magic objects never came off the friends, so they were superheroes, and they kept the city safe forever.

THE END.



Kitty Catastrophe

By: Mahiya Srivastava

“Ok class today Deekshita and I will be discussing the next writing topic,” Zuha says promptly. Mahiya is so lucky because she has a puppy, her puppy is just so cute. I have a kitten who is so cute but practically hates me,” Zuha thought as Mahiya showed her Milly.

“I will just send them into breakout rooms,” Deekshita texts Zuha. Deekshita and Zuha continue with the writing class. At the end of the class, Zuha is dreading getting back to her home life. Zuha thought to herself, life with 3 siblings is tough even though I am the oldest. I just wish I could switch lives with anyone just anyone ... oh Mahiya, switching lives with Mahiya would be the best.

“Ok class, today Deekshita and I will be discussing the next writing topic,” Zuha says promptly. Zuha is so lucky she is the oldest child. I’m the youngest child and I always get bossed around so much. A 5-year difference between me and my brother makes a huge difference. Zuha also continues to tell us that she doesn’t need to do anything for her cat because her mom and sister do most of the things. All of her siblings probably respect her so much. She could have so much freedom to do anything. Then finally after an eternity of observing Zuha teach and her life, I realize she has a life that is much less complicated, I wish I could switch lives with her, I think just before class ends.

Suddenly a glitch comes on the computer screen and wind swirls like a tornado. I manage to get sucked into the computer and into Zuha’s house. When I look back at the Zoom meeting I see Zuha at my house, but only for a second until she changes in my body. But I don’t see a change until I see the reflection on the screen. At that same moment, the Zoom meeting ends. GREAT JUST GREAT! Just when I have to talk to Zuha, the zoom ends! JUST FABULOUS! :(

“Zuha, come down NOW!” Zuha’s mom yells.

“Coming,” I tell her.

“NO NOW,” she yells. I know that Zuha did something that she would be in trouble. I scatter hurriedly downstairs and into the kitchen after 1 attempt to find her mom.

“ZUHA ANJUM YOU ARE IN BIG TROUBLE! WHY DID YOU THINK IT WAS A GOOD IDEA TO SEND TOBY OUTSIDE?” She says in a questioning voice.

“Umm....” I say but really I have no idea.

“You know what happened the last time Faiq (little brother) did that. Toby came home with a dead mouse in its mouth!” She informatively tells me.

“I’m so sorry...” I say but I get interrupted. I get interrupted by Zuha’s cat walking into the house all muddy and wet. His paws are all wet and slimy. Now I am used to having to bathe Milly (my puppy), but you hear the stories of cats getting vicious when you bathe them.

The next thing I know, I am in the bathroom outside of the bathtub with an adorable kitten in my hand who somehow likes me. I think he could tell that something is different about Zuha

(which is me in this situation) but he liked it. I have yellow rubber gloves on and Toby in my hands terrified for his life.

“Ok, Toby it’s ok kitty, I will just quickly give you a bath,” I tell Toby nervously.

“Deep breath in and let it out. Maybe if I get a glass with water put it in the tub and then give him a bath like that, he will like it?” I think to myself. Finally, after what feels like an eternity, I dip the glass in water and pour it on the kitten.

“Ouch!” I say to Toby. Ok, this didn’t go to plan... so I poured the water on Toby until he jumped off my one hand and I spilled the water. At first, it didn’t seem like a big deal until the water spread everywhere which caused me to slip. And that’s not the worst of it now Toby is on the loose with his muddy mess. UGH! I first decide to clean up the muddy mess in the bathroom and then find or rather catch Toby. Now I see why Zuha doesn’t take care of him because he is

just ... just too much work! Milly is a ton of work but now I am used to her, everyone thinks that cats are so easy to poop in a litter box and mind their own business but they are a problem of their own. Eight minutes later and I pretty much cleaned the bathroom and myself. I trail the muddy paw print to a neat and tidy room. The door opened all the way and the paw prints continued to the baby pink bedsheet.

“Tobias Imus Anjum!” I heard someone yell by the doorway. I turned around to know that the worst was going to happen.

“Zuha?” I hear from the corner of the hall. I instead don’t reply. I quickly got the kitten off the bed and I was lucky he did not go anywhere else. I throw the comforter that Toby is sitting on-off the bed. Toby runs out of the room and into the bathroom. Great, just great, as soon as Zuha’s mom calls Toby runs to the bathroom. I ran back to the bathroom too and then responded, “Yes Mama?”

She responds by saying, “Why is Toby’s paw prints everywhere?”

“I’ll just clean it,” I say back.

I quickly clean the pawprint and finally, after ages, I get the chance to clean Toby. I try the same thing again with the glass and everything but don’t say Mahiya you will make the same mistake over again but no I put him on a leash. I successfully clean Toby and do a little victory dance. Then, I have to tackle a new problem which is buying a new comforter for Zuha’s sister Fatima. I run into the hallway and see a room that has Zuha in cursive on it.

I barged into the room and looked everywhere and saw a wallet. I open it and it has money and a small kitty and Zuha’s picture on the right side. I then see the Andrew Jackson’s, The Abraham Lincolns, and then the best ones, the Benjamin Franklins. I pull out the Benjamin Franklin and hope that it is enough for the comforter. I go up to Zuha’s mom and ask her “Mama can you please take me to the shops ... I want to buy Fatima a new comforter but want it to be a surprise.”

“Oh how nice Zuha,” she said. Then next thing I know we are in the car and at the store. I walk straight to the bedding aisle and find the comforter. I find the perfect pale blue color with white stripes on the end of it.

“Mama, can we get this one?” I ask Zuha’s mom.

“Sure, Zuha, it’s perfect. She will love it,” Zuha’s mom tells me.

I purchase the comforter and we head home. I am so fed up with the day, maybe my life is way better than Zuha’s. Just then I switched with Zuha and came to my house happily ever after! The end.

Now that would be such a bad way to end a story and especially this story and that is not all how it ends. FINE I’ll tell you the real ending.

OK, where was I oh yeah. Then, I get an email from Zuha (who is at my house) saying that she wants to have a Zoom meeting so we can “talk about the class.” I make a Zoom meeting and invite her. While I do that, there is a glitch on the computer and it suddenly starts the meeting. While I am waiting for Zuha, I go to her sister’s room and swap the comforter and write

a note saying that “I hope you like it, from Zuha.” Then, Zuha joins the meeting and we see each other and at the same time, we think “I wish I was at my house and then we switch.”

The end. Now that is also not how it ends this is the real ending I promise.

So I don’t see Zuha when she joins but I see Milly and then I bring Toby into the frame. I hear them meow and bark at the same time, but differently and weirdly and they both at the same time nuzzle on me and Zuha on our wrist. It was strange and then we both see the glitch and ended up at our home and we still don’t know what the animals did, but they were a lifesaver. So that’s the end of my cat catastrophe.



Toby



Milly



The Neighbor Switch

By: Meghna Srivarshini

Do you like gardening? Well, if you do, please do *not* read this because you will *never* want to be gardening ever again in your life?

It all started on a nice Winter day on New Year’s Eve and I felt bad for the poor lady watering her garden so I went over to her house and offered to help.

“I can help you with your garden if you want?” I asked.

“Oh that would be lovely dear,” the old lady replied. I offered to help for one day, but the old lady kept asking me for *days* and it soon became weeks. I can feel my head start to spin every afternoon as I walked down to the garden everyday and soon enough, I realized the old lady’s plan. I had been planting and watering and planting and watering on repeat while the old lady sat there giving me orders. Soon enough I knew everything about planting and I was miserable

One day, I went to get the watering can to fill it up and the old lady was coming for the watering can to pour it on her plants, and in a blink of an eye, I was staring at myself. For some reason, I was holding a cane and I was wearing big but skinny clothes.

“What a miracle! I think my back pain is gone!” the old lady said happily.

“Ow I think I got back pain,” I said in pain. It took me a while to realize that the old lady and I had switched bodies!

“I feel so great! I think I am going for a mile. Man, it has been so long since I have done that. Well later, grandma!” said Gladys, the old lady.

“Excuse me! You are the grandma and that is my body you are in,” I said in a jealous tone, but Gladys had already left.

I sat in the chair looking at the watering can in disgust when I saw two grown men looking at the watering with their jaws open wide.

“What are you looking at?” I asked.

“W... Where did you get that old watering can?” the man asked, taking a step back.

“It’s just a plain old watering can,” I lied.

“Oh no, that’s no ordinary watering can! Frank, you remember right?” the man said turning to the other man.

“Oh, I remember Robert. Oh dear, do you think it happened...” Frank whispered.

“I don’t even know what you’re talking about.” I lied again.

“Did you switch with someone?” Robert asked.

“Yes. I switched with an old lady named Gladys and she is in my body right now and she went for a run,” I admitted.

“Oh well, it’s good we found you because the same thing happened with me and Frank. It took us some time to switch back but we got it eventually.” Robert explained.

“You switched back! How?” I asked eagerly.

“Well Frank and I did a lot of research, but lucky for you, you don’t have to go through the trouble we did because we know where the other watering can is. But the only problem is that the other watering can is an hour away at my mom’s house for safekeeping and neither of you guys know how to drive.” Robert explained.

“Couldn’t you guys drive us? I asked.

“We could but we have to use Frank's car. You ok with that Frank?”

“I guess so,” Frank said glumly.

“But we have to wait for Gladys to come back,” I said.

“Ok, we can wait. We’ll be waiting. By the way, we live across the street., Robert said. I waited for Gladys to come back and finally after three hours she came back.

“Hey! I hope you don’t mind, but I found a twenty-dollar bill in your pocket and I used it to get this bike. And also I don’t want to be in your body anymore. It's so stressful and you’re not allowed to go in some places,” Gladys complained.

“Glad to hear you say that because I found a way for us to switch back!” I said.

“Really now?” Gladys asked.

“Well I came across Robert and Frank, your neighbors, and they said that they have switched, too! So then they told me how to switch back and they said that to switch back you have to have another water can. But we got lucky so Robert and Frank know where the other watering can is so we can switch back!”

“Hurray!” Gladys screamed.

“But the watering can is in Robert’s mom’s house and it’s an hour away.”

“Oh no! We can’t go now it’s nearly dark.”

“So while you were gone I made up a plan so you can tell my parents that you are spending the night at your friend’s house, but really you will be sleeping in your house. Also, I have a question. Can I spend the night at your house?” I asked.

“Sure I have an extra room.”

“Great! I’ll just go tell Robert and Frank that we’ll come tomorrow.”

I woke up the next day feeling tired like I slept for five minutes last night, but I remembered that today they would travel to Robert’s mom’s house and I would be switched back into my normal body.

“Oooh owwww my back!”

“Morning!” Gladys said.

“Hello, are you ready to get switched back?”

“I am so excited to be back in my normal body! I get to water my plants every day and I can relax wherever I want to!” Gladys said excitedly.

Gladys and I brought everything we should bring and walked over to Robert and Frank’s house. KNOCK KNOCK KNOCK!

“Come in!” Roberts shouted from upstairs.

“Hello, both of you packed to leave?” Robert asked.

“YUP!” Gladys and I said.

“Alright then. FRANK! THERE HERE WE CAN GO NOW!” Robert shouted. Frank walked down the stairs.

“Ok! Well, my car is in the back. I’ll go get it and I will wait in the front.” Frank explained. When I walked outside Frank set the music in the car so high it seemed as though the car was singing but Frank lowered the volume down until you heard the music faintly.

“Well, what are you waiting for? Hop on inside.” Frank said. When I stepped inside the car I smelled fresh air from the air conditioning and the seat warmers were quite warm. I realized why Frank was so nervous about letting us be in his car. He wanted to keep his car clean and he knew that people would ask again to come and he was right. I would want to have another ride in his car.

When the ride was over Robert insisted that he would go inside and get the watering can so we agreed. When Robert came back he said, “Now that we have the watering can we have to go to the same exact place you two were switched or the switchback won’t work.”

“Aww man, I was so eager to be switched back. I miss my cane,” Gladys whined.

“We have to wait another hour so stop whining,” Robert scolded. When the ride home was done Gladys and I went to the exact place they were switched.

“Are you two ready?” Robert asked. I nodded, “Ok then.”

Robert placed the watering can beside and in a blink of an eye, I was staring at Gladys as a grandma!

“YAY! We did it!” I screamed, “Wow it’s been a long time since I have been in my real body. I think I am good to go a mile.”

“Well, later grandma. I said and I ran off.”

“Well that hurt,” Gladys said.

The End.

✦✦ **SPOTLIGHT STORIES END HERE** ✦✦



The Switch

By: Anjali Vijayanand

“Wanna hear a story?” I say to my hotdog.

“Guess that's a yes!” I say.

I'm hungry. I say in my mind, *LETS ORDER GRUBHUB!* I get on my computer and go to the website. “I want sushi,” I say. I order and wait.

“DING DONG!” The doorbell rings. I open the door and say thank you to the Grubhub man.

I take a bite of my food and immediately start to feel weird like I am hallucinating. I see diamonds all around me and I am dancing. Suddenly, I am in bed.

I wake up. But I’m not myself... I AM MATT MALONEY (CEO of Grubhub) “WHERE AM-”

Suddenly, a guy appears in my room, “Sir! Sir! You're late for work!”

I reply, “WHO ARE YOU AND ALSO I'M A GIRL!”

“No you're not sir, and also I’m Bob Maloney, your brother.”

“YOU'RE HIS BROTHER--I MEAN MY BROTHER???”

“Um sir are you ok?”

“Um yes! Let's go to work.”

“Sir, you forgot to change.”

“Uh yeah.”

At work... “Hey boss!” a guy suddenly says from out of the blue.

“Hey!” I yell in a fake manner.

“So, are you ready for the mission?” he asks.

“Yup!” We hurry down the hallway into this secret darkroom. And there even was a portal inside!

“OH MY LORD!” I say. I walk inside of it and suddenly appear in this parallel universe! I see this guy with black hair and glasses. He was dancing with a half-eaten burger in front of a

red diamond background. "I KNEW IT!" I say excitedly, "I KNEW THERE WAS SOMETHING FISHY ABOUT GRUBHUB!" :D

"What was that sir?" Bob's brother said.

"What do you mean?"

"I KNEW IT YOU'RE NOT MY REAL BROTHER!"

"BAHAHA AND I KNEW THERE WAS SOMETHING FISHY ABOUT GRUBHUB! I'M GONNA TELL EVERYONE!"

"Oh no, you're not. I'm gonna erase your mind!" At the mind erasing lab... "STOP NO PLEASE!" I say nervously.

"Too bad!" he says.

Suddenly, I wake up and I'm back to my body! I wake up in my house, my bed, my closet AND EVEN MY DOG! "WHAT?! WHEN?! HOW?!" I looked into the mirror and it was me! I even remember the Grubhub secret!



A Harry Potter Switch

By: Annika Jivrajani

It was a cold winter day; I was in my brick cabin on a velvet couch near the warm toasty flames. My black-and-brown beagle, Micky, had just come inside from the snow trying to get near the toasty fire. As I squinted at him, I saw a small rubbery object in his mouth. I went closer to him to grab it. I took the rubber object from his mouth.

"What's this boy?" But before he could send out any sound or bark of communication, I saw circles spinning.

Finally, the circles stopped and I was in front of a castle, but not just any castle... the *Hogwarts castle*. I was freezing. All I was wearing was a pink shower robe. Suddenly, I saw someone outside.

"I-it was Hagrid," I thought. At first, I did not know what to do. I finally decided to take the risk. I walked up to Hagrid

"H-Hey Hagrid," I said

"Oh-Hey there Harry!" He said in a cheerful voice

"What ye doin' up so late?"

"Me? I'm not Harry!"

"Who ar' ye den? Some troll who broke into Hogwarts?" Hagrid laughed at his own joke.

"Well, ye betta get the bed! Don't want anyone cachin' ye!" I went up the stairs and up to "my" room with the boys. I went up to the stairs that changed positions every time. Don't ask me

how, but I found my way to the Gryffindor common room. And Ron was pulling on Harry's robes.

"WHO ARE YOU AND WHAT HAVE YOU DONE TO HARRY!!" Ron shouting. Then he turned his head to me.

"H-Harry thank goddess you're alive!" Ron said breathing heavily. Ron came up to me and gave me a hug and his messy orange hair all over his face. I was very disgusted by his old-pizza breath that I could probably smell from a mile away.

Without hesitation, I quickly said: "I'M NOT HARRY HE IS!" I pointed to my real body forcefully.

"Ha-Ha very funny!" Ron said, forcing a laugh.

"I am not joking! He's me, Annika!"

We switched for some reason," the real Harry said. Ron kept looking at me, then Harry several times. He tried to smile, I did not work

"THIS IS A NIGHTMARE!" Ron said flopping himself on his bed roughly.

To be Continued...



The Big Switch

By: Jasveet Kaur

"Mom! Why can't I sleep at eleven? Manny gets to do it!" I said upset.

"He does not get to sleep at eleven! It's just hard to make him sleep!"

"But his life is so easy! He sleeps at eleven, wakes up at ten, he only has preschool, and he sleeps in a room with a TV that stays on until ten!" I said, trying to contain my anger.

THE NEXT DAY...

"Hey! I found the wand toy!"

"Jazzy, give Manny a turn with it too," said my mom

"But I didn't get to play with it yet and he is trying to snatch it from me!"

"Okay, you can play with it for 5 minutes and then give Manny a turn."

"Ugh, okay" I mumbled under my breath. "But I still think I should not give this to Man (what I call my baby brother)."

Just then the wand lit up by itself! It said, "You should share with your brother."

"Ahhhhhhhhhhh! You just said something!" I was terrified

"Yes. Okay now, where was I? Oh yes, you should share with your brother.

"But what if he breaks something? Then he cries to me to fix it and I have to fix what he broke!"

"Or he might not break it."

"Yeahhhh sure... I'll only believe you if you like, switch us or something."

“Hey, that is a good idea! I can switch you and your brother!”

“Wait! I didn’t mean that literally! But it was too late. The wand had switched me with my brother.”

“SWITCH US BACK!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!!” I yelled.

“Sorry, the spell stays for 24 hours.” Then the wand made a clock come to life.

“ This clock will time you two for 24 hours until you switch back.”

“Awww! This is going to take forever!”

“It will only take 24 hours. Not forever,” the clock and the wand said together.

Jazzy dragged through the day. She figured out preschool was too easy for her.

All she had to do was paint the letter z and listen to a book. Then she/he (Remember they switched) ate and watched T.V the rest of the afternoon.

Meanwhile, fourth grade was too hard for Manny.

“What are fractions?” He asked our mom who was with him.

“Manny, I’ll tell you what fractions are later. Just sit in the class, listen, and then Jazzy will do the work while you stay here in class and they still think you are actually Jazzy.”

“Okay, but couldn't we just have told them that we were both sick?”

“The wand said if we do that, you two will switch back only in one year.”

“Okay.” By now it was 23 hours. Just one more hour and they would switch again.

“Go to sleep and you will switch back in one hour,” Mom said, “Just pretend that this crazy day never happened.”

ONE HOUR LATER...

I woke up at 12:00 to luckily find myself in my normal body. “ Manny Manny!!! We switched back!!!”

“I think my work is done here,” the wand said. Now you two have to promise me that you will share,” our parents and the wand said.

“We promise,” we both said.

“Good. Well, Time for me to make another pair of siblings share! Bye!”

“Bye!” we all said.



Allen to Myself

By: Jeffery Chen

I was riding my scooter in the hot arid air while desperately wanting to get water into my mouth. I was listening to the birds holler at each other while the moisture dried in my hands. I couldn't tell which smell was stronger: my dad’s cooking or the fresh metal of the scooter.

I entered the garage password and suddenly my mind began to spin. When I finally shook off the spinning I felt normal and went inside. I took a look around and didn't feel normal. I thought this house was different and looked faintly familiar. White carpet with gray stripes, covered the small floor. The dining room had a big chandelier and eight chairs eagerly waiting for people to sit.

When dinner was ready, I was starving. I could smell Dominoes' barbecue chicken and cheese pizza. Anderson started talking about Bee Swarm. I started to think why Anderson was at my house, but this house didn't even look like my house. I had a delicious dinner and I wondered what we were going to do next. I followed Anderson upstairs, and he asked me to play Brawl Stars with him. I said yes and we played until his mother said to sleep.

This isn't my bed. Where are my stairs that lead to my bed? Barking filled the room, and I couldn't sleep. I was just about to sleep when an idea hit my head, and I went to sleep dreaming about my own body.

The next day I was getting dressed into Allen's "super hungry" shirt and fussy pants. I asked Allen's mom if we could go to the park with Jeffrey's family.

Allen's mom said, "好 (translates to "Yes" in English)" and I told Anderson.

We went outside and hopped into the car and drove to the park. While we drove I talked about Beeswarm Simulator and about the secret passages that are hidden around the map. I said that there was a secret passage in the werewolf cave. Anderson asked what was in it. I replied that there was a golden egg. We finally reached the park and I got off with Anderson. Allen and I went off and got the scooters. Then, we started talking about the weird stuff that happened in each other's house. Once we touched our scooters I felt seasick and dizzy. After a few minutes it felt better. I looked down at myself and saw my own body. I also saw Allen looking down at his body too. Then, we set off together in the snow.



Change with 5th Grader

By: Krishna Siddharth

I was watching the Avengers Endgame movie and Thor was about to die. I felt like punching Thanos really hard and killing him. Suddenly, some kind of tech interference opened a portal and put me in the tech zone. In the process, my mind swapped with Thor. Mjollnir sent me to space then to the new Asgard.

Everyone was yelling, "Oh my God! Thor killed the mad Titan two times now!" We had a party and it was fun.

It was really exciting at the start then I had to fly through planet killers. We had a bigger problem than Thanos! When the infinity stones went through the Quantum Realm they created a monster that can leap through time.

“Yeah even though this is a little cool we need to stop this somehow. This can’t keep going on and if it does I’m gonna get you kicked off the gymnastics team,” said Sanjana.

We both got off the bus and headed into school. Over there I met Anjali who was standing across the hall.

“So are you ready for the lacrosse game today? It’s going to be a big one,” she asked

“Yup totally ready I guess. By the way, I forgot what time it is again?”

“3 o’clock this afternoon,” she said enthusiastically.

School just got over so we decided to meet at her house. Over there she taught me how to even hold a lacrosse stick which was already hard enough so forget to use it while I taught her how to do a round off. We both knew that we were most likely going to get kicked off the lacrosse team and gymnastics team.

Right after that I suited into her lacrosse gear and got ready for the game. I got there and got onto the court. The other girl looked about the same age as me with brown hair and a baby blue shirt, but way more comfortable holding the stick.

The game went, HORRIBLE. I didn’t get a single point and the whole time I was just standing there looking dazed. Also, now I have to tell Sanjana the bad news. After practice, I got kicked off the team! This is horrible, Sanjana’s going to kill me. When we got back she came straight to her house. Over there, she told me that my coach was really mad at her too.

“We need to figure out what to do!” said Sanjana

“Ok, I think the reason we switched was because of what we said last week. I said that lacrosse is so much easier than gymnastics and you said that gymnastics is much easier. Now I know that lacrosse is so much harder and I shouldn’t judge something if I haven’t done it,” I said in a rush

“And I think that gymnastics is also way harder than it looks,” she responded

A weird feeling went through my body and we were back. It was cool at first but I’m glad it’s over. I’ll never judge a book by its cover again.



My Mom’s Life

By: Sahana Jayathilak

As I woke up and went to the bathroom to wash my face I screamed. I looked like my mom! I ran to my mom’s room and saw her scream.

“What happened?” she asked.

“I don’t know,” I said.

I went to ask my grandfather and he said, “I switched you both.”

“Why?” I asked.

“So that you both will understand how hard each other’s lives are. Plus, you will switch back by midnight,” he replied.

“Ok, I will last for one day!!” said my mom and me nervously.
I made a list of things we had to do:

Mom (me):

- Get ready for work
- Drive the car
- Look at what I have to do for today
- Finish what I have to do at the office
- Drive the car back home
- Make dinner
- Switchback

Me (Mom):

- Get ready for school
- Ride the bike
- Go to classes
- Finish classes
- Ride the bike eat dinner
- Switchback

As I walked downstairs I saw my dog staring at me. “Don’t look at me like that?” I said.
“WOOF!” I hurried out the door and hopped on my bike.

Suddenly, I remembered that I have to drive the car. As I went into the car, I held the steering wheel and put my feet onto the pedals. It actually felt really familiar. I drove to the office and went inside. Everything felt familiar, the face, this place, the things, and the writings were too. So I went to my mom’s desk and filled the papers.

By the time I was finished, it was 5:00 pm! I quickly drove the car to my house and saw myself standing at the front door.

“Sorry,” I said to my mom.

“At least you’re here,” she sighed in relief. I opened the door and smelled pizza.

“YUM,” we both said.

“What is this aroma?” I asked.

“Pizza,” said my grandpa. My mom and I washed our hands and sat down to eat. After dinner, we cleaned up and went to bed. The next morning, I was me again and my mom was her again!



The Big Spell!

By: Sanjana Vijayanand

Before my friend came over, I looked into the mirror and made sure I was looking clean. I had my black hair brushed. My nice black pants and my blue shirt are all nice and tidy on me. I had my bracelets all tied together! "I can't believe I just finished the whole series of Harry Potter," I can't wait to tell my friend Lexi. DING DONG! I went to the door and got it. Lexi was here. We went up to my room.

Lexi said, "Wow, your room is so neat."

"Thanks," I replied

Lexi replied, "I know right, hey, let's go onto Youtube and see who the actors are for the movies. Also, I heard they will show clips of them auditioning." I couldn't wait to see Hermione's audition, "Oooh, here she is."

I watch very carefully as Hermione auditions

"It's Leviosia not Leviosa," says the girl auditioning for Hermione - Emma Watson. In my mind, I get so mad that there's literally smoke coming out of my ears.

"SHE SAID IT WRONG. She doesn't even know what she's saying NOR does she look like what she is supposed to, ugh. I would've been a better actor than her," I say.

WOOOOP! Huh, what's going on? I feel a zap. I feel different. I am suddenly in a room. There is a big nice sign that says EMMA WATSON. While we were watching the video I did see that name. I ran to the mirror in Emma's room whoever that is. I yelled so loud that birds flew away. Emma Watson was the actor of Hermione Granger in the new Harry Potter movie. When I was about to walk out of the room to look around, Emma's mom walked in.

It's like I'm in someone else's body. I felt different inside and out. I look at my hair ITS BROWN NOW! Then I look at my clothes and they look so different from mine. I walk to the mirror. I'M IN EMMA WATSON'S BODY!!!!!! Then, I realize that I have to act like Emma Watson until we can fix this. Emma's mom walks in and she says, "Hi Emma sweetie, you ok?"

I say, "Oh, hi mom, yeah I'm fine."

Emma's mom says, "Hey honey, make sure to get ready for tomorrow, it's a big day, your first scene of Harry Potter."

I mutter, "First scene tomorrow."

"Huh," says Emma's mom.

"Nothing," I exclaim.

After Emma's mom leaves the room. I run outside and start sprinting towards the direction of my house. Once I've reached my house I see the real Emma we both walk towards each other. I say, "What's going on, why am I in your body, and why are you in mine."

The fake me says "I have no clue," I pant in tiredness!

The real Emma explains to me all about the first scene of Harry Potter. I tell her all about the play I had in school. The real Emma hands me the paper of lines I need to practice for the first scene of Harry Potter. I once again sprint to Emma's house, I sit on her bed and start reading over the lines. The next morning, I wake up to a fresh smell of pancakes and orange juice.

Emma's mom walks in and says, "Good Morning sunshine, today's a special day!"

I reply, "Morning." I walk to Emma's bathroom and brush my teeth. I actually love her toothpaste. After I've finished I rummage through her closet to find some clothes. I find some clothes to wear and saunter down to the kitchen. I have a hard time finding where that is.

Once I reached the kitchen, I sat down at the table. I get so excited when I see Emma's siblings Toby, Alex, Lucy, and Nina. I wave in excitement, they all wave back with a weird expression on their faces. I eat the pancakes eagerly and stand up.

I ask Emma's mom, "Hey mom, where is my costume?"

She answers, "In my bedroom sweetie." I walk upstairs and go into her bedroom, and take the costume, and put it on.

Mrs. Watson runs into the room and says, "We only have 30 minutes, come on let me do your hair." After my hair was done I told my mom I would be a sec, I ran to my house.

I saw the fake me and asked her "Is there anything I should know before I leave?"

The fake me responded, "No, not really, anything I should know?" asked the real Emma "Be amazing in my play tonight." The real Emma nodded. I ran back to Emma's house.

When I got a second to look, I saw how big their house was and all the beautiful bricks. I saw the windows, squeaky clean.

"Oh, how beautiful," I thought. Then I saw Emma's mom. We were ready to go. I got in the car. It felt like my phone was talking to me when it suddenly rang. I picked it up.

This voice said, "Hey Emma are you gonna be here soon?"

I said, "Where?"

The voice responded, "At the meeting place for the first scene of Harry Potter."

I exclaimed, "Yes, almost there!"

Once we reached, I walked inside with butterflies in my stomach. I saw all the castles. So beautiful, with a color of gray-ish. The set looks so big. I got soooo excited when I saw Daniel Radcliffe and Rupert Grint. I ran to them in happiness and said, "OMG HI!!!" They both said "hi" back at the same time.

I said, "Sorry to be weird but can I have a pic."

Daniel Radcliffe said "sure" and I took out my phone so we could take a pic together! A few minutes later....

We all lined up and started our parts first of course with Dumbledore, Hagrid, and McGonagall. Then came Harry Potter then us later on though. When it was my turn I walked up

and said my lines. I stuttered a few times.... After I was done I sighed in relief that I didn't do that bad. Then that's when I realized being an actor is so hard and Emma Watson was a great one.

ZAP. BOOM! I looked at my hair and I was back!!!! I landed outside my house. I ran inside and gave everyone a big hug. "BEST DAY EVER!!!!!"

